

in their own time for alternatives that might be easier to work with and offer greater functionality at the same time. App Grid is a handy alternative to Ubuntu's Software Centre that you could try!

Written from scratch, App Grid claims to provide considerably better start up and response times as well as an intuitive interface. Of course, there are some shortcomings—it makes use of a gridded background pattern among some other minor drawbacks which users could ignore since it's so responsive and takes such less time to load content. However, one aspect that open source fans might resent is that App Grid is closed source! If you're ready to overlook these factors, App Grid is available for Ubuntu 12.04 LTS, 13.10 and 14.04 LTS.

Simply add the following PPA to your software sources to install it:

```
sudo add-apt-repository -y ppa:appgrid/stable
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get install app grid
```

You can use the .deb installer, too.

Kwheezy to change its name to Kebian once Debian Jessie gets stable

In tune with how Kubuntu represents Ubuntu, Kwheezy will most likely change its name to Kebian, once Debian Jessie becomes the stable Debian version. Notably, Kwheezy is a Debian 7 Wheezy fork that uses KDE as the default desktop environment.

Readers will recall that the latest version of the system is Kwheezy 1.5. It is based on Debian 7.4 and uses KDE 4.8.4 as the default DE and kernel 3.2. The Debian Installer team earlier announced the arrival of the first Alpha build of the Debian 8 'Jessie' version. Debian developers are known for releasing highly stable builds. The Debian 8 Jessie Alpha 1 release is therefore being pitched as one that is almost free of all kinks.

It can be recalled that Jessie is the development version of Debian, for which work has been under way for quite some time now. The Debian 8 Jessie Alpha 1 is the first major official release from the Debian stable. The default desktop environment in the new Debian 8 Jessie is Xfce; however, a final decision on the exact environment to be shipped with the final release is expected to come in August 2014.

Apache launches Spark to boost Hadoop

In a bid to speed up jobs that run on the Hadoop data-processing platform, the Apache Software Foundation has announced the first production-ready release of its analysis software, 'Spark'. Data-analysis jobs created by Apache Spark could run almost 100 times faster as compared to standard Apache Hadoop MapReduce jobs. No wonder it has been dubbed as the 'Hadoop Swiss Army knife'.

MapReduce has been widely criticised for executing jobs in batch mode,



It's official: Ubuntu One is now gone for good!

Canonical has finally withdrawn its Ubuntu One service after announcing it was axing the Dropbox competitor earlier this year, as the South African firm goes all out to focus on its operating system. Canonical clearly lives by the theory of 'survival of the fittest', since it has also stopped its streaming music service. Users must mark their calendars since stored data will be available for download only up to July 31, after which, all stored data will be lost forever.

Canonical had earlier attributed the lack of paid users and increased competition from Google Drive, Dropbox and other cloud storage services as the reason behind its own service floundering. "If we offer a service, we want it to compete on a global scale. For Ubuntu One to continue to do that would require more investments than we are willing to make," CEO Jane Silber was quoted in a blog post.

So here's how you can grab your data before July 31, 2014:



- Simply log in to your Ubuntu One account and hit the orange button found under the main notice. You'll receive all your data as a .zip file.
- If you're looking for a direct import tool, Canonical has teamed up with cloud storage migration service, mover.io, for this very purpose. Simply create your account and transfer your data (approx 2 GB) to other services, such as Dropbox, Google Drive, etc, for free. Meanwhile, annual subscribers will receive a pro-rated refund soon.